

Chapter 1 - Geospatial Health

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Geospatial Health Data

- provides information to identify health problems when they occur.
- crucial to prevent and control infectious diseases, non-communicable diseases, injuries, and other health conditions.
- one of the earliest examples is John Snow's cholera-outbreak investigation in 1854 which helped identify the source of infection (a public water pump on Broad Street).

Disease Mapping

- provides a visual summary of spatial information
- allows identification of patterns that may be missed when data are presented in tabular format.

Communication of Results

- Do not forget that the goal here is not to merely collect data for analysis, but to guide public health policy and action and help control and/or prevent diseases.
- target audience: health agencies, governments, private organizations, potentially exposed individuals, general public, etc.